Newspapers by ancestry
https://www.newspapers.com/image/442796353

Downloaded on Jul 8, 2020



ELSIE OLIVER

CHARITY BELL



FEMKE ROSENBAUM



ANGELA AND TOM MENINO



CHRISTOS SOILLIS



MARGARET McCAULEY



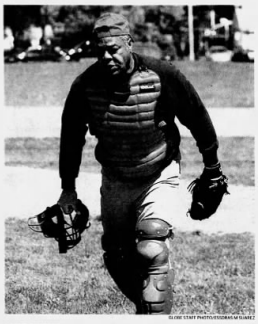
JARRETT BARRIOS



A MUSICIAN PERFORMS DURING A CRITICAL MASS BIKE RIDE

What do you think?

Who do you think made a difference in your community this year? Let us know in 75 words or less at ciweek@globe.com. Please include your name, community, and a daytime phone number.



LAZARO PONCE

Her post-job soul-searching led her to an eight-week photography class in Cambridge. A class project focused on her pregnant sister-in-law in natural lighting, emphasizing the beauty Carreras found in the expectant mother. A quick business model later, and Maternal Glory Photography was born. No posed shots of kids or mommies with teddy bears for Carreras.

"With a baby on the way," says Carreras, "life-changing decisions were easy. I was thinking to myself, 'What kind of person do I want to be for the child? The kind of person who plays it safe or explores other things?' I'm wanting so desperately to be someone my child can benefit from and be proud of."

WHO: Jonathan Evans and Tim Wientzen, Chestnut Hill

WHAT: Campus heavyweights for the small coffee farmer.

"Coffee is a part of most kids' lives," says Tim Wientzen, 21, a junior at Boston College. "When you tell people there's a coffee that can help millions of people, they listen."

Wientzen and fellow junior Jonathan Evans spearheaded the successful effort to have Fair Trade coffee sold at all campus outlets last fall. They are part of a nationwide move to ensure that campus coffee sales (think about how much coffee goes down on campus) don't unintentionally contribute to the ruination of land through slash-and-burn farming and to the destruction of small farms through concentrated distribution systems that favor huge plantations.

Evans and Wientzen held teach-ins at BC last spring, gaining the support of 17 student groups and campus minister Evan Cuthbert. "They are rather unassuming, but they are very passionate and very direct," says Cuthbert of Evans and Wientzen. "They don't pull any punches."

Evans carried a secret during the fight: He doesn't like coffee. "Maybe after dessert," he says. "But mostly, I like the challenge of trying to stay awake."

WHO: Ken Granderson, Dorchester

WHAT: Linking neglected areas of Boston to the Web

Some people moan about the technology gap between the well-to-do and the less fortunate. Ken Granderson is finding ways to get people in Roxbury, Dorchester, and Mattapan to want to move online.

The president of Inner City Software, a Dorchester company, started roxbury-.com last February, a site that contains news, events, a list of local churches, and a directory of area businesses and organizations from restaurants to child-care centers. Similar sites for Dorchester and Mattapan may follow.

"We needed to figure out ways to present technology to people that was relevant to where they were and what they were interested in," says Granderson, 36, who in 1997 started Boston Blacks On-Line, an online cafe in which conversations range from movies to politics.

To Laurie Sparrowhawk of the Cruz Computer Learning Center in Roxbury, roxbury.com is "a way for the neighborhood to have its own specific interests and identity out there on the Internet."

WHO: Femke Rosenbaum

WHAT: Bringing fun (and stilts and lantern festivals) to Jamaica Plain

Did we mention Brazilian street dancing? Friday night ethnic food gatherings? Relentless costume making, flag twirling, float-building?

All are part of the determined high jinks of Femke Rosenbaum's Spontaneous Celebrations. The former Dutch schoolteacher's group has created two major traditions in Jamaica Plain and supported the emergence of Latino culture in the neighborhood, said artist Stephen Baird, a former executive director of the Jamaica Plain Arts Council. "She is part of the fabric of what JP is."

The deal for kids: Complete your homework here, and art and fun follows. As state cutbacks threaten grants that have sustained her afterschool programs, Rosenbaum, 58, has launched paid memberships and publicized the Friday night shindigs to raise money. No one doubts Rosenbaum's optimism or industry.

"You can do," she says, "with very little."

WHO: Lucas Brunelle, Fenway

WHAT: Keeping the drive alive to make Boston's streets safe for bicyclists

Not only does Lucas Brunelle take part in controversial monthly take-back-the-streets rides by the loosely organized pro-cycling group Critical Mass, he hitches a trailer and tows a sofa, or sometimes a band, through Boston's roadways.

The Fenway computer instructor has endured the horn-honking of motorists delayed by the two-wheeled procession and listened to criticism that the in-your-face-pollsters approach to drivers doesn't win his cause any allies.

Still, he keeps pedaling at the rallies, which occur in more than 300 cities. For a few hours, with the strength of numbers, bikes actually have the upper hand in Boston's deadly road wars.

"It gets people to think," he says. "It may get negative attention, but it brings attention to the issue. It's a celebration of bicycles and everything they can do for the environment."

WHO: Jarrett Barrios, Cambridge

WHAT: Becoming the first Latino state senator in Massachusetts

Doorsteps. Coffee shops. Endless talking. Jarrett Barrios, 34, knew he had to work hard to win a district that looked tailor-made for his chief rival, A Harvard-educated, openly gay Latino, running in a mainly white, blue-collar area that had been represented by state Senate President Tom Birmingham, Barrios managed a convincing primary victory over Cambridge City Councilor Anthony Galluccio in September.

A campaign budget twice that of Galluccio's and hard work made the victory happen. It was one of several by Latino candidates, including Jeffrey Sanchez of Mission Hill, who topped a five-way field for state representative. Waiting in the wings: Felix Arroyo, of Hyde Park, who will be sworn in in January as the first Latino on Boston's City Council.

WHO: Elsie Oliver, Newbury Street

WHAT: A move up from elevator operator to art expert.

Nearly six decades ago, Elsie Oliver joined the Great Migration, taking a Greyhound bus from her North Carolina home to Boston and getting a job running an elevator.

Robert Churchill Vose Sr., of the Yankee family that owned the Vose Galleries, soon offered her another job, and she stayed at that one until her retirement this year.

In that time, she rose from elevators to shorthand to highly detailed knowledge on European etchings, abstract paintings, and 16th century art. "She knows all these gallery names and owners and clients that nobody else would know, says Terry Vose, Robert's grandson, who now runs the business with his twin brother, Bill.

As a girl, Oliver was deemed too fragile for the jobs many young African-American women were funneled into at the time, such as housecleaning. She missed perhaps 10 days in 59 years on the job once with pneumonia, and once when she hurt her back tobogganing. "People kept asking me if I planned to work forever," she says. "And I would say, I just might. I may be an old lady, but I feel great."

WHO: Lenny Zakim

WHAT: Making an impact after his death.

The sounds of a bootleg Grateful Dead recording blared for dignitaries in a mid-day drizzle on Oct. 4.

It was made by Zakim, for whom the dignitaries had gathered to dedicate a modern monument: the Leonard P. Zakim Bunker Hill Bridge.

The spirit of the recording, on such a crummy day, reflected his upbeat nature, which helped him connect blacks and Christians and Jews in this often-fractious city.

Although he went global in conversations with the pope and the Dalai Lama, he was such a master in his down-home work as director of the Anti-Defamation League of New England that he spawned an army of anonymous do-gooders who toil in his memory.

Three years after he died of cancer at the age of 46, the city still echoes with Springsteenesque (a friend) standing o's.

WHO: Margaret McCauley, South Boston

WHAT: Staying at the post.

For four decades, her husband has spent weekend nights ferrying Margaret McCauley from her home to her spot: checking coats at Boston College High dances.

Indeed, while mop-tops, bell-bottoms and exposed navels come and go, Margaret McCauley does not.

She represents a kind of continuum of souls who provide an anchor as change -- in this case, rock, disco, punk and hip hop -- sweeps through.

"Oh, my God!" gasps one alum at a 20th reunion. "She's still there."

"That was Joe O'Brien," offers McCauley without missing a beat. "He used to be president of Student Council."

WHO: Tom Menino, Readville

WHAT: Taking care of his most important constituency.

Hours after it became official that Boston was going to win the 2004 Democratic National Convention, Angela Menino sat downstairs at the Four Seasons Hotel while her husband wrapped up a dinner appearance upstairs.

Proud that her husband delivered, she was also beat -- she hoped to head straight home, watch the 10 o'clock news and hit the sack.

To her, one thing stood out from her husband's performance: he rang her first thing, straight-away, after the conference call in which Democratic officials made their choice.

Now that's worth noting: a person who calls his companion right away when good news happens.

Copyright © 2020 Newspapers.com. All Rights Reserved.

Powered by Newspapers.com